

Should You Switch to Serverless Computing?

There's a lot of buzz around serverless computing. But should everyone shift to it? And why? Here are some insights.



Cloud Technology

Serverless doesn't refer to a non-existing server. Basically, serverless computing is a cloud-computing execution model where machine resources are allocated on demand by the cloud provider, which also takes care of servers on behalf of the customers. Hence, it can also be termed as a method of providing backend services as per usage. The advantage is that companies who get backend services from serverless vendors are charged based on usage and not a fixed amount of bandwidth or the number of servers used.

Why serverless?

In server based systems, it is important to manage infrastructure. This includes server/cluster provisioning, patching, operating system maintenance and capacity provisioning. Such management can be eliminated in serverless computing, helping us focus on just the application and its requirements.

Early physical systems had a lot of maintenance issues, added to the long time taken to deploy them. These were followed by servers being managed in virtual machines, but there was still a

lot of complexity involved. Next came containerisation, which eased big and complex applications. But all these systems were server based. The idea of serverless has transformed computing infrastructure, as it does not need server management and can be scaled flexibly. Scaling can be done for customers who use the application, thus optimising costs. With flexible scaling, there is no idle capacity, which leads to high availability.

The rate of adoption of serverless computing is increasing every year, making public cloud providers and